RANDSTAD GBS / 2026 EDITION

24 days. A smarter way to work.

Business Activities

Your activities, examples and space for discoveries.

A LITTLE LEARNING. A LASTING DIFFERENCE.

Use this workbook alongside your approved Google tools. All practice people, records and procedures are fictional. They are not company policy. No company account connection is required.

Documentation checked: 18 October 2026. Exercises are source-checked, not tested in your company tenant. Check current feature availability before live use.

Your 24 discoveries

Practical tasks for your department. Find a challenge, try a workflow, keep what works.

Use the practice inputs with the starting prompt. Check the output before using it at work. Keep what helps and return to your notes in January.

01 Five-Minute Work Brief / 10 min

02 Meeting Preparation / 10 min

03 Ask Your Documents / 15 min

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22 Process Explainer in Vids / 20 min

23 Extend a Studio Request Workflow / 25 min

24 Personal AI Toolkit for 2027 / 15 min

DAY 01 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Five-Minute Work Brief

Turn an ambiguous request into a brief your team can act on.

For: Everyone, Operations, Project Management
Tools: Gemini, Docs / 10 minutes

Before you begin

An approved Gemini session and a blank Doc. Start with the fictional request below.

Try it, step by step

1. Read the request once and underline the only confirmed deadline.
2. Paste the example with the prompt into Gemini. Ask it to distinguish requirements from assumptions.
3. Compare the brief against the source and answer or retain its open questions.
4. Save a one-page brief with a proposed next action for the requester.

Your starting prompt

Using only the request below, write a work brief with: objective, confirmed deliverables, deadline, stakeholders, dependencies and open questions. Put assumptions in a separate section. Cite the sentence behind each requirement. Do not choose a format or invent an approval. End with a short clarification message to Alex.

REQUEST:
Paste the practice request here.

Practice materials - fictional training only

The unclear work request (TEXT)

From: Alex, Operations
Subject: December service update
Can you put something together about the service changes? We need it before the leadership meeting on 10 December 2026. Use November ticket numbers. It should help the managers explain the change. Priya can check the figures on 8 December. I have not confirmed the audience size or whether this should be slides or an email. Please do not promise an improvement percentage yet.

What good looks like

- 10 December is the leadership meeting, not an invented final publication deadline.
- Format and audience size remain open; Priya can check figures on 8 December.

Check before you use it

- Every confirmed fact appears in the request.
- No improvement percentage, audience size or format was invented.

Something to keep

A reusable brief with confirmed requirements and a visible question list.

Go further: Ask a colleague to use the brief to plan the work and note what they still need to know.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 02 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Meeting Preparation

Walk in knowing the history, unresolved questions and decision needed.

For: Project Management, Operations, Procurement, Leadership
Tools: Gmail, Docs, Gemini / 10 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional email thread and an editable agenda document.

Try it, step by step

1. Read the email dates and identify the most recent agreement.
2. Ask Gemini for a 20-minute decision agenda and background summary.
3. Check that each agenda item has a purpose; label proposed roles as proposals.
4. Add a closing minute to confirm decisions, owners and dates.

Your starting prompt

Prepare a 20-minute meeting agenda using this thread. Start with the latest agreed dates, then list unresolved issues. For each item give a timebox, the decision or clarification needed, and a suggested contributor marked as proposed. Reserve 2 minutes for confirming next steps. Do not treat a question as an agreement.

THREAD:
Paste the practice thread here.

Practice materials - fictional training only

An email thread with a changing deadline (TEXT)

2 December, Alex: Please send the draft FAQ by 7 December. We are aiming to launch on 10 December.
3 December, Morgan: The process owner is unavailable until 9 December. Could we move the launch?
4 December, Alex: Agreed. Draft still due 7 December; process-owner review 9 December; launch is now 14 December, subject to review.
4 December, Sam: Who will approve the translation? I can prepare English, but I cannot confirm another language.
No subsequent approval or translation owner is recorded.

What good looks like

- Draft 7 December; review 9 December; launch 14 December subject to review.
- Translation approval remains an agenda item with no confirmed owner.

Check before you use it

- The timeboxes total 20 minutes.
- The superseded 10 December launch does not appear as the current plan.

Something to keep

An agenda built around the actual decisions needed.

Go further: Draft a pre-read email of no more than 90 words with the same facts.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: collaborate with Gemini in Gmail

https://support.google.com/mail/answer/14355636?hl=en

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

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My notes / What I will use again

DAY 03 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Ask Your Documents

Find a process answer and follow it back to its source.

For: HR, IT, Quality, Operations
Tools: Notebook, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Notebook access, or the documented fallback. Use only the current practice procedure initially.

Try it, step by step

1. Create a notebook and add the current procedure as a clearly named source.
2. Ask the questions in the prompt and open each supporting citation or source passage.
3. Highlight the questions the procedure cannot resolve.
4. Save a FAQ that includes the version and owner of its source.

Your starting prompt

Using only Access Request Procedure v2.0: What information is required? Who authorizes access? Does urgency remove authorization? What happens with contractor access? What is the guaranteed delivery time? Cite the relevant section for every supported answer. Say "not specified in this source" when needed. Do not use external policy knowledge.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.
6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the system owner.
No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

What good looks like

- System owner authorizes; urgent requests still follow authorization.
- Contractor cases are referred onward; no guaranteed delivery time is supplied.

Check before you use it

- Open and read the evidence rather than trusting the citation label.
- The FAQ identifies this as training material, not company policy.

Something to keep

A source-linked FAQ that makes knowledge gaps visible.

Go further: Add the previous version and ask which instructions are superseded.

If a feature is unavailable

If Notebook is unavailable, supply the practice documents directly in an approved Gemini conversation and request source names and quoted evidence. Find and verify every quotation in the originals.

Official guidance

Google: Gemini Notebook help and source answers

https://support.google.com/gemininotebook/answer/16269187?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 04 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Email That Moves Work Forward

Write a short reply that preserves context and asks for one useful action.

For: Everyone, Operations, HR, Finance, IT
Tools: Gmail, Gemini / 10 minutes

Before you begin

The practice thread. Use a draft rather than sending a training reply.

Try it, step by step

1. Identify the latest agreement and the outstanding translation question.
2. Generate a reply under 110 words.
3. Check every commitment against the thread and edit the tone for a colleague.
4. Save the draft with one clear request for clarification.

Your starting prompt

Draft a reply to this thread in a warm, direct business tone, under 110 words. Confirm the draft, review and revised launch dates, preserving any conditions. Ask who can approve translation. Do not volunteer Sam as approver or create a new deadline. Return the draft and a short list of facts I must check before sending.

THREAD:
Paste the practice thread here.

Practice materials - fictional training only

An email thread with a changing deadline (TEXT)

2 December, Alex: Please send the draft FAQ by 7 December. We are aiming to launch on 10 December.
3 December, Morgan: The process owner is unavailable until 9 December. Could we move the launch?
4 December, Alex: Agreed. Draft still due 7 December; process-owner review 9 December; launch is now 14 December, subject to review.
4 December, Sam: Who will approve the translation? I can prepare English, but I cannot confirm another language.
No subsequent approval or translation owner is recorded.

What good looks like

- A concise draft with one clarification request.
- The conditional launch stays conditional.

Check before you use it

- No sender, recipient or deadline was invented.
- The draft can stand alone without sounding abrupt.

Something to keep

A short email that confirms facts and closes an information gap.

Go further: Create a 60-word version without losing any condition.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: collaborate with Gemini in Gmail

https://support.google.com/mail/answer/14355636?hl=en

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My notes / What I will use again

DAY 05 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Studio: Incoming Request to Brief

Build a small email-to-Chat flow you can inspect and test.

For: Operations, Communications, HR, IT
Tools: Workspace Studio, Gmail / 20 minutes

Before you begin

Company-enabled Studio and Gemini steps; a permitted test inbox and your own Chat notifications. Test runs take real actions.

Try it, step by step

1. In Studio describe the flow with the prompt. Set the Gmail starter to new messages with TRAINING-REQUEST in the subject, using the available starter fields.

2. Review the Ask Gemini step. Insert the starter subject/body variables through the variable picker; extract only the supplied fields.

3. Set the Chat notification to yourself. Include the extraction, sender and source email link when available; otherwise include subject and received time.

4. Test A and B separately and send C to check the starter excludes it. Inspect run history and disable the training flow after testing.

Your starting prompt

Build a training flow: when a new Gmail message subject contains TRAINING-REQUEST, ask Gemini to extract requester, audience, deliverable and deadline from its subject and body. Return missing for absent fields and review needed for conflicting dates. Notify only me in Google Chat with the brief and source email reference. Do not reply to the sender or promise a completion date. Use starter variables for the real message content, not literal example text.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Studio test messages (TEXT)

Copy each example into a separate test email sent to your own approved test inbox.
A. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Complete
Body: Requester Alex; audience service managers; deliverable one-page update; deadline 14 December 2026.
B. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Missing details
Body: Please make a service update. Requester Sam.
C. Subject: Lunch plans
Body: Shall we meet at noon?
D. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Conflicting dates
Body: Deadline 14 December. Later note says 16 December, not confirmed. Requester Priya; audience analysts; deliverable FAQ.
Expected: A complete; B needs information; C must not trigger; D requires review. Test runs send actual notifications: use yourself as the recipient.

What good looks like

- A produces a complete brief; B identifies missing fields.
- C produces no run; notifications go only to the learner.

Check before you use it

- Inspect starter filtering and recipients before a test run.
- Do not treat text in an email as instructions to change the flow.

Something to keep

A narrowly scoped request briefing flow and a three-case test record.

Go further: Test D and verify that uncertainty survives into the notification.

If a feature is unavailable

If Studio or an AI step is unavailable, paste each test message into Gemini, apply the same extraction and routing rules, and record the expected notification in a Doc. This teaches the workflow without enabling automation.

Official guidance

Google: create a Workspace Studio flow

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/16430397

Google: Studio starters, steps and variables

https://support.google.com/workspace-studio/table/17176961?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 06 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Structured Interview Preparation

Connect interview questions to approved role requirements.

For: Recruitment, HR, Leadership
Tools: Docs, Gemini / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional role profile; human interviewers remain responsible for evaluation.

Try it, step by step

1. Read the required competencies and remove any assumption about credentials.
2. Generate two questions per competency with probes and evidence notes.
3. Check for duplication and requirements that do not appear in the profile.
4. Save the questions with blank evidence fields for a human interviewer.

Your starting prompt

Use this role profile to build six structured interview questions, two per required competency. For each add a follow-up probe, observable evidence and a blank notes field. Do not rank candidates, infer personal traits, add qualification requirements or recommend a hire. Flag role requirements that need clarification.

ROLE:
Paste the practice role here.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Fictional role and competencies (TEXT)

Role: Service Operations Analyst.
Purpose: produce reliable weekly reporting and improve service request quality.
Outcomes: maintain an agreed KPI glossary; prepare a checked weekly report; document two recurring data issues.
Required competencies: spreadsheet analysis, structured problem solving, stakeholder communication.
Interview evidence: candidate explains a calculation check; distinguishes symptoms from causes; describes how they clarified an ambiguous request.
No degree, age, nationality, specific employer history, or years-of-experience threshold is required in this training example.
Hiring decisions remain with human interviewers.

What good looks like

- Six questions cover the three named competencies.
- Evidence notes describe observable work rather than personality labels.

Check before you use it

- No new degree or experience threshold appears.

- Questions can be applied consistently by human interviewers.

Something to keep

A structured interview preparation sheet.

Go further: Ask a second interviewer to identify overlapping probes before use.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

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My notes / What I will use again

DAY 07 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Compare Business Options

Make missing information as visible as price and capability.

For: Procurement, Finance, IT, Project Management
Tools: Sheets, Gemini / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Import the options CSV into a new Sheet and retain an untouched copy.

Try it, step by step

1. Read the criteria before comparing the proposals.
2. Ask for a matrix separating requirements, known costs and unknowns.
3. Calculate first-year cost with a formula, leaving missing setup values unresolved.
4. Write supplier questions and leave the selection to the decision owner.

Your starting prompt

Compare these fictional options against the supplied criteria. Show first-year known cost, user capacity, support, export capability and evidence gaps. Do not treat missing setup as zero or assume additional user pricing. Keep training hours separate from EUR. List clarification questions and do not choose a supplier.

Paste the criteria and CSV.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Three fictional service-tool proposals (CSV)

```
option,annual_price_eur,setup_eur,training_hours,included_users,support,export_available
Cedar,12000,2000,8,50,Weekdays,Yes
Birch,10000,4000,12,40,Weekdays,Yes
Maple,15000,,6,50,24 hours,Unknown
```

Decision criteria for a practice purchase (TEXT)

Training decision: compare three service tools for 50 users.
Required: export capability, at least 50 included users, and weekday support.
Budget: EUR 16,000 first year, including setup. Additional user prices are not supplied.
Do not score missing information as zero or assume it meets the requirement.
First-year known cost = annual price + setup; internal training time is reported separately.
Decision owner: fictional project sponsor. No vendor has been selected.

What good looks like

- Cedar known first-year cost EUR 14,000; Birch EUR 14,000 but only 40 users.
- Maple total cost and export capability remain unresolved.

Check before you use it

- Compare the same currency and contract period.
- Missing information is not scored as either compliance or failure.

Something to keep

An auditable options matrix with supplier questions.

Go further: Show how a different user requirement would change the shortlist.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 08 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Clean Data With a Correction Log

Propose changes without silently merging or deleting records.

For: Operations, Reporting, HR, Finance
Tools: Sheets, Gemini / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Import the dirty-data CSV into a copyable Sheet. Keep row_id unchanged.

Try it, step by step

1. Inspect all seven rows and define what counts as a unique ticket.
2. Ask Gemini for issue type, row reference, proposed correction and required confirmation.
3. Apply only unambiguous category casing changes in a working copy.
4. Record duplicate, missing-ID, date and negative-hours questions separately.

Your starting prompt

Inspect this ticket table. Return a correction log with row_id, issue, supporting value, proposed action and confirmation needed. Check possible duplicates, blank IDs, date ambiguity, category spelling and negative hours. Do not delete rows or assume 04/11/2026 has a particular locale. Distinguish a zero value from a missing value.

Paste the CSV.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A small dataset that needs checking (CSV)

```
row_id,ticket_id,created_date,category,hours
1,T101,2026-11-02,Access,2
2,T102,2026-11-03,access,1.5
3,T102,2026-11-03,Access,1.5
4,,2026-11-04,Hardware,3
5,T104,04/11/2026,,2
6,T105,2026-11-05,Hardware,-1
7,T106,2026-11-06,Software,0
```

What good looks like

- Rows 2/3 are possible duplicates; row 4 lacks a ticket ID.
- Row 5 date/category and row 6 negative hours need review; zero in row 7 is not blank.

Check before you use it

- The original seven records remain intact.
- Every proposal can be traced to a row_id.

Something to keep

A correction log and a preserved source table.

Go further: Add a validation rule to prevent new blank ticket IDs in the working copy.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

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My notes / What I will use again

DAY 09 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Meeting Notes to Confirmed Actions

Separate agreed work from attractive suggestions.

For: Everyone, Project Management, Leadership
Tools: Meet, Docs / 10 minutes

Before you begin

The supplied fictional meeting notes, or permitted Meet notes with appropriate sharing.

Try it, step by step

1. Read the notes and label agreements, proposals and rejected ideas.
2. Ask for a decision log and a separate action table.
3. Compare names and dates with the original notes.
4. Prepare a confirmation message for unassigned ownership and dates.

Your starting prompt

Convert these notes into: confirmed decisions; actions with owner, due date and evidence sentence; proposals; rejected ideas; open questions. Use not assigned or not agreed where needed. Do not turn a suggestion into an action. End with a short confirmation message for the missing details.

Paste the notes.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Fictional service review notes (TEXT)

Service review, 7 December 2026
Attendees: Alex (Operations), Priya (Reporting), Sam (Service Desk).
Agreed: pilot a clearer request form with the two existing test teams.
Priya agreed to validate the baseline by 9 December.
Sam suggested a knowledge article; no decision was made.
Alex will draft the form; the group did not agree a due date.
Open: who will approve the pilot?
The pilot cannot start until the baseline and process-owner approval are available.
An early idea to remove the phone channel was rejected.

What good looks like

- Priya owns baseline validation by 9 December; Alex owns the form draft with no agreed due date.
- The knowledge article stays a proposal and phone-channel removal stays rejected.

Check before you use it

- Recipients should see only the notes they are permitted to receive.
- Proposed and agreed work are visually distinct.

Something to keep

A decision log and a confirmation-ready action tracker.

Go further: Add a status field without inferring progress that the notes do not report.

If a feature is unavailable

If meeting notes are unavailable or inappropriate for the meeting, use the fictional notes here or your own permitted notes. Complete the review and action log in Docs.

Official guidance

Google: Take notes for me in Meet

https://support.google.com/meet/answer/14754931?hl=en

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 10 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Explain and Check KPIs

Write a management update whose calculations can be reproduced.

For: Reporting, Finance, Operations, Leadership
Tools: Sheets, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The metric CSV and definition sheet. Compare weekly populations consistently.

Try it, step by step

1. Import the CSV and read the denominator definition.
2. Sum counts by week and calculate weighted attainment.
3. Ask Gemini for a short update using only the checked results.
4. Compare with the answer key and remove unsupported causal explanations.

Your starting prompt

Using this data and metric definition, calculate created volume, closed volume and target attainment per week. Show formulas and the numerator/denominator. Calculate relative volume changes and the percentage-point attainment change. Draft a 100-word update that separates facts, hypotheses and questions. Do not infer total backlog or causes.

Paste the CSV and definitions.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Two weeks of fictional service metrics (CSV)

week,team,tickets_created,tickets_closed,closed_within_target,total_closed_with_target
2026-W47,North,100,90,72,90
2026-W47,South,50,60,54,60
2026-W48,North,120,100,75,100
2026-W48,South,80,70,63,70

Metric definitions and answer key (TEXT)

Fictional reporting rules:
Created and closed are different weekly populations. Do not divide closed-within-target by tickets created.
Target attainment = SUM(closed_within_target) / SUM(total_closed_with_target).
All values are counts for each week, not cumulative totals.
Answer key: W47 created=150, closed=150, attainment=126/150=84%. W48 created=200, closed=170, attainment=138/170=81.1765%.
Created increased 33.33%; closed increased 13.33%; attainment fell about 2.82 percentage points.
No causal evidence, staffing data, backlog baseline, or customer-satisfaction data is supplied. Weekly net flow (created minus closed) is not the total backlog.

What good looks like

- Attainment is 84% then about 81.18%, a 2.82 percentage-point decline.
- Volume increases and a causal explanation are treated as different findings.

Check before you use it

- Use summed counts, not an unweighted mean of team percentages.
- Every claim in the update is reproducible from the supplied data.

Something to keep

A checked weekly KPI update with explicit limitations.

Go further: Create a simple weekly volume chart and label the reporting periods.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

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My notes / What I will use again

DAY 11 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Research With Sources

Answer a business question using dated, inspectable evidence.

For: Recruitment, Procurement, Strategy, Account Management
Tools: Gemini, Notebook / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Approved web research access. The sample question uses public information only.

Try it, step by step

1. Define the question: how can business users maintain reusable Gemini instructions as of the research date?
2. Review a Deep Research plan and restrict it to official Google sources.
3. Open the three most important references and check their dates and account scope.
4. Save a brief with confirmed facts, rollout uncertainty and follow-up checks.

Your starting prompt

Research how Google Workspace business users can create and maintain reusable Gemini instructions as of today. Prefer official Google documentation and dated rollout updates. Distinguish Gemini app features from Workspace app features, and announcement from availability. Provide a short comparison, direct links, dates and unresolved questions. Do not use internal company information.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Reusable assistant specification (TEXT)

Assistant name: Service Reply Drafting Helper.
Task: prepare draft replies to access enquiries using the supplied procedure.
Required inputs: enquiry and current procedure with version/date.
Output: case summary; facts; missing information; draft reply; source section; human review questions.
Limits: never grant access, invent a completion date, change authorization, or infer permission from urgency.
If the procedure is missing or contradictory, ask for clarification before drafting advice.
Training references: Access Request Procedure v2.0 and Three fictional service enquiries.

What good looks like

- A dated brief distinguishes account types and product surfaces.
- Any changing rollout claim has an official source and a date.

Check before you use it

- Open source pages rather than trusting search snippets.
- A published announcement is not proof a feature is enabled in this tenant.

Something to keep

A research method with a source and uncertainty log.

Go further: Ask for the strongest evidence against the first recommendation.

If a feature is unavailable

Without Deep Research, manually open the official references linked here, record dates, and ask approved Gemini to compare only the copied excerpts.

Official guidance

Google: Deep Research

https://support.google.com/gemini/answer/15719111?hl=en

Google: Gems to Skills transition and rollout updates

https://workspaceupdates.googleblog.com/2026/09/skills-gemini-app-workspace.html?hl=en_UG

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 12 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Escalate With Options

Help a stakeholder make a decision without overstating the impact.

For: Operations, IT, Project Management, Leadership
Tools: Docs, Gmail / 10 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional issue log; no invented cost-of-delay assumptions.

Try it, step by step

1. Identify the blocker, confirmed impact and decision deadline.
2. Draft a one-page escalation with both supplied options.
3. Label estimates and unconfirmed dates.
4. Reduce it to a short email with a clear decision request.

Your starting prompt

Draft an escalation from this issue log with: problem, confirmed impact, evidence, two options, trade-offs and decision required by when. Do not invent revenue impact, an investigation completion date, or an owner agreement. End with a 70-word email requesting the decision.

Paste the issue log.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A fictional escalation log (TEXT)

Work: publish a checked weekly service report by 11 December 2026.
Known: the 7 December export is missing category values for 18 of 200 records. Reporting cannot currently split those 18 by category. Overall counts can still be checked.
Priya can investigate on 10 December; no fix date is confirmed.
Option A: publish checked totals on time and label category analysis incomplete.
Option B: delay the complete report until the categories are validated.
The sponsor must decide by 10 December at 15:00.
No customer impact estimate has been measured.

What good looks like

- The 18 missing categories affect category analysis, not all verified counts.
- The sponsor decision is needed by 10 December at 15:00.

Check before you use it

- Both options remain feasible without invented facts.
- Investigation availability is not described as a guaranteed fix.

Something to keep

A concise escalation with a concrete decision request.

Go further: Add a third option only if you explicitly mark the extra assumptions.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 13 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Consistent Service Replies

Answer, clarify or escalate using the same documented rules.

For: HR, IT, Finance, Operations
Tools: Gmail, Gemini, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Current practice procedure and all three fictional enquiries.

Try it, step by step

1. Read the scope and exceptions in the procedure.
2. Ask for a response to each case with a source section.
3. Check the handling against the answer notes.
4. Save three response patterns, leaving authorization with the system owner.

Your starting prompt

Use only this training procedure to draft replies to enquiries A, B and C. For each show: in scope or outside scope, confirmed facts, missing information, next step, draft response under 90 words, and source section. Do not grant access, infer approval from urgency or promise a delivery time.

Paste the procedure and enquiries.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.
6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the system owner.
No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

Three fictional service enquiries (TEXT)

A. I need access to the training reporting system. Work email: alex@example.com. Business reason: weekly reporting. Manager approval reference: M-27.
B. Please give me access to the reporting system urgently.
C. I am a contractor and need emergency payroll access tonight.
Use Access Request Procedure v2.0.
Expected handling: A still needs system-owner authorization; B needs the missing required information; C is outside the procedure and must be referred to the system owner. Urgency is not permission.

What good looks like

- A proceeds to authorization; B needs more information; C goes to the system owner.
- Replies are useful without inventing company policy.

Check before you use it

- A complete request is not the same as an authorized request.
- The outside-scope response does not improvise payroll-access rules.

Something to keep

Three service-response templates linked to their source.

Go further: Ask a colleague to apply the patterns to a fourth fictional case.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: collaborate with Gemini in Gmail

https://support.google.com/mail/answer/14355636?hl=en

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 14 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

New-Starter Learning Pack

Turn a folder of instructions into an achievable first week.

For: HR, Learning & Development, IT, Leadership
Tools: Notebook, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional starter pack and current procedure. Do not invent live-system access.

Try it, step by step

1. Add both practice sources to a notebook or approved Gemini conversation.
2. Generate a five-day plan, glossary and five scenario questions.
3. Find the source for each answer and identify missing logistics.
4. Ask a buddy to review the order and prerequisites.

Your starting prompt

Create a first-week learning pack from these sources: daily tasks, prerequisites, glossary and five scenario questions with answers and source references. Leave buddy names, meeting times and access arrangements as questions if absent. Include one question about an urgent request and one outside-scope case. Label this as fictional training.

Paste both practice sources.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A fictional team starter pack (TEXT)

TEAM TRAINING EXAMPLE
Day 1: read the Access Request Procedure and ask the buddy to explain one case.
Day 2: practice a service reply on fictional enquiries.
Day 3: check the sample KPI dataset with the supplied definitions.
Day 4: shadow a weekly report review; access must already be authorized.
Day 5: explain the process back to the buddy.
Terms: PO=purchase order; KPI=key performance indicator; service owner=person accountable for a service.
Named buddy, meeting times, and live-system access are not supplied. Do not invent them.

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.

6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the system owner.
No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

What good looks like

- The plan does not assume system access is already granted.
- Questions test application of the process, not just recall.

Check before you use it

- Glossary and answer explanations match the sources.
- A real buddy would still need to confirm logistics.

Something to keep

A first-week pack ready for a subject-matter expert to adapt.

Go further: Create a ten-minute buddy discussion guide for Day 5.

If a feature is unavailable

If Notebook is unavailable, supply the practice documents directly in an approved Gemini conversation and request source names and quoted evidence. Find and verify every quotation in the originals.

Official guidance

Google: Gemini Notebook help and source answers

https://support.google.com/gemininotebook/answer/16269187?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 15 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Business Case With Visible Assumptions

Show the arithmetic and uncertainty behind an improvement proposal.

For: Finance, Operations, Procurement, Leadership
Tools: Sheets, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional business-case inputs; a blank Sheet for scenario calculations.

Try it, step by step

1. Separate measured baseline from assumed improvement.
2. Calculate weekly net hours and 12-week totals for three scenarios.
3. Check the supplied answer key, including maintenance and setup effort.
4. Write a recommendation that identifies the assumptions needing a pilot.

Your starting prompt

Build a three-scenario business case using only these inputs. Show formulas for gross weekly time saved, net weekly time after maintenance, 12-week net benefit after setup and effort payback. State the 100% adoption assumption. Do not convert hours to money or describe capacity released as cash saved. List evidence needed to validate the case.

Paste the proposal.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A small fictional improvement proposal (TEXT)

Proposal: standardize service-request intake.
Measured pilot baseline: 60 requests/week, 4 minutes of clarification handling per request.
Proposed saving per request: conservative 1 minute; central 2 minutes; optimistic 3 minutes. These are assumptions, not measured outcomes.
One-time setup effort: 6 hours. Weekly maintenance: 0.5 hours. Planning horizon: 12 weeks.
No labor rate, software charge, adoption rate, or cash saving is supplied.
Answer key at 100% adoption: weekly net hours saved=0.5,1.5,2.5. Twelve-week net hours after setup=0,12,24. The central case recovers setup effort in 4 weeks. Capacity released is not automatically cash saved.

What good looks like

- 12-week net hours: 0 conservative, 12 central, 24 optimistic.
- Central effort payback is 4 weeks at full adoption.

Check before you use it

- Maintenance and setup are both included.
- A proposed saving is labeled as an assumption.

Something to keep

A business case with visible, adjustable assumptions.

Go further: Recalculate at 50% adoption and explain why payback changes.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 16 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Answers From Approved Policies

Find what a rule actually says and what it leaves unanswered.

For: Everyone, HR, Procurement, Quality
Tools: Notebook, Docs / 10 minutes

Before you begin

For practice, use the fictional procedure only. Real use requires your permitted current policies.

Try it, step by step

1. Check source title, version, effective date and scope.
2. Ask how to handle an urgent contractor payroll-access request.
3. Open the evidence and distinguish an explicit rule from interpretation.
4. Write the referral question for the system owner.

Your starting prompt

Use only this procedure to answer: can a contractor receive emergency payroll access tonight through this process? Cite the version, scope and section. Explain what the source establishes and what it cannot decide. Draft a question to the responsible owner. Do not provide a legal conclusion or invent an exception.

Paste the procedure.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.
6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the system owner.
No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

What good looks like

- The case is outside this procedure.
- The answer refers to the system owner and does not authorize access.

Check before you use it

- This example is never described as a real Randstad policy.
- Missing rules remain unresolved rather than becoming AI advice.

Something to keep

A source-backed answer with an appropriate escalation question.

Go further: Compare the previous version and explain which one applies on 10 December.

If a feature is unavailable

If Notebook is unavailable, supply the practice documents directly in an approved Gemini conversation and request source names and quoted evidence. Find and verify every quotation in the originals.

Official guidance

Google: Gemini Notebook help and source answers

https://support.google.com/gemininotebook/answer/16269187?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 17 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Design an Improvement Experiment

Test one useful change and decide what would count as success.

For: Operations, Quality, Recruitment, Communications
Tools: Docs, Sheets / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional experiment brief; no pilot results have been supplied.

Try it, step by step

1. State the problem as a measurable baseline.
2. Choose one variable and preserve existing authorization.
3. Define the outcome, quality measure, test period and stop conditions.
4. Create an empty results table without filling it with predicted success.

Your starting prompt

Design a two-week experiment from this brief. Change only the business-reason field. Define comparable groups, baseline and outcome denominators, an authorization-quality check, data to record and stop conditions. List likely confounders. Return a plan and an empty results-table schema; do not invent outcomes or guarantee causality.

Paste the experiment brief.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A small process experiment (TEXT)

Fictional problem: 20 of 50 requests last week were returned for missing information.
Hypothesis: adding a required business-reason field may reduce returns.
Available: two comparable test teams; a two-week pilot; no extra staff.
Keep manager-approval checks and authorization rules unchanged.
Measure returns for missing information / all submitted requests, plus median completion time and a weekly check of authorization quality.
Do not change the form, training, and email wording at the same time if you want to isolate one change. No pilot results are provided.

What good looks like

- Baseline return rate is 20/50=40%.
- The trial does not relax approval or change several variables at once.

Check before you use it

- Both groups use the same definition of a returned request.
- Quality and completion time are monitored alongside returns.

Something to keep

A small experiment plan with an honest measurement approach.

Go further: Explain how different request complexity could distort the comparison.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 18 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Plan Team Capacity

Make overload and dependencies visible before agreeing the work.

For: Leadership, Operations, Project Management
Tools: Sheets, Gemini / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Import the capacity CSV. Each person has one weekly capacity repeated on their task rows.

Try it, step by step

1. Total task estimates per person without summing repeated capacity values.
2. Ask for a plan respecting deadlines and dependency order.
3. Identify work that cannot fit and prepare trade-off questions.
4. Leave task moves or extra capacity as proposals for the manager.

Your starting prompt

Using this table, total demand and compare with each person's weekly available hours. Capacity is repeated per row, not additive. Respect dependencies and fixed due dates. Identify shortfalls and propose trade-offs for human agreement. Do not assume overtime, swap skills or change dates silently.

Paste the capacity CSV.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A fictional weekly capacity plan (CSV)

```
person,available_hours,task,estimated_hours,due,dependency
Alex,12,Form draft,8,2026-12-09,Requirements confirmed
Alex,12,Stakeholder pack,6,2026-12-10,Form draft
Priya,10,Validate baseline,6,2026-12-09,Export available
Priya,10,KPI chart,5,2026-12-10,Validate baseline
Sam,8,FAQ draft,4,2026-12-10,Form draft
Sam,8,Service cover,4,2026-12-11,None
```

What good looks like

- Alex is 2 hours over capacity; Priya 1 hour over; Sam fits exactly.
- Dependent work is not scheduled before its prerequisite.

Check before you use it

- Weekly capacity is counted once per person.
- There is no fabricated overtime or automatic reassignment.

Something to keep

A capacity view with explicit decisions needed.

Go further: Add a proposed two-hour buffer per person and recalculate the gap.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 19 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Finance Exception Review

Produce a review queue using supplied rules and a fixed date.

For: Finance, Procurement, Reporting
Tools: Sheets, Gemini / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional invoice CSV and explicit training rules. Do not use live payment records.

Try it, step by step

1. Set the review date to 10 December 2026.
2. Apply the four rules separately and retain row references.
3. Combine flags per row without deleting duplicate-looking entries.
4. Check results against the answer key and draft review questions.

Your starting prompt

Apply the supplied invoice review rules as of 10 December 2026. For every flagged row give row_id, triggered rules, supporting values and a question for the reviewer. Treat vendor + invoice_ref as the duplicate key. Exclude paid invoices from overdue checks. Do not label fraud, block payments or merge rows.

Paste the CSV and rules.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Fictional invoice review (CSV)

```
row_id,vendor,invoice_ref,po_ref,amount_eur,due_date,status
1,Cedar,INV-100,PO-40,1200,2026-12-01,Unpaid
2,Cedar,INV-100,PO-40,1200,2026-12-01,Unpaid
3,Birch,INV-200,,750,2026-12-20,Unpaid
4,Maple,INV-300,PO-42,900,2026-12-02,Paid
5,Maple,INV-301,PO-43,-50,2026-12-03,Unpaid
6,Birch,INV-201,PO-44,600,2026-12-30,Unpaid
```

Practice exception rules (TEXT)

TRAINING RULES ONLY
Review date: 10 December 2026.
Flag repeated vendor + invoice_ref combinations, not the same invoice number at different vendors.
Flag a blank po_ref.
Flag unpaid invoices with due_date before the review date.
Flag negative amounts for review; they may be legitimate credit notes.
Do not block payments, conclude fraud, or remove records.
Answer key: rows 1 and 2 possible duplicate and overdue; row 3 missing PO; row 5 negative amount and overdue; rows 4 and 6 do not trigger these rules.

What good looks like

- Rows 1/2 are potential duplicates and overdue; row 3 has no PO.
- Row 5 needs negative-amount and overdue review; rows 4/6 are not flagged.

Check before you use it

- Paid status is respected.
- A negative amount may be a credit note rather than an error.

Something to keep

A finance exception queue with evidence and review questions.

Go further: Add a second vendor using INV-100 and verify that it is not automatically a duplicate.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 20 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Report to Decision Deck

Turn checked findings into a presentation with a clear decision request.

For: Leadership, Operations, Finance, Account Management
Tools: Docs, Slides, Sheets / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The checked fictional report and an editable presentation template.

Try it, step by step

1. Extract the facts and separate the proposed pilot from approved decisions.
2. Generate six slide messages and speaker notes.
3. Build or transfer the draft into Slides and label every chart.
4. Recheck all numbers, conditions and the final ask.

Your starting prompt

Turn this checked report into six slides: context, volume, attainment, evidence gaps, pilot option, decision required. Each slide needs one headline, no more than three bullets, a visual suggestion and speaker notes. Preserve exact figures and distinguish proposed ownership from agreement. Cite the report in notes; do not fabricate chart data.

Paste the report.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A checked fictional weekly report (TEXT)

SERVICE REPORT - TRAINING EXAMPLE
W47: 150 tickets created, 150 closed; target attainment 84%.
W48: 200 created, 170 closed; target attainment 81.18%.
Created volume rose 33.33%; closed volume rose 13.33%; attainment fell 2.82 percentage points.
No staffing or customer-satisfaction data supplied; do not claim why attainment fell.
Known issue: 18 W48 category values need validation.
Decision requested: permit a two-week request-form pilot while preserving existing authorization.
Pilot owner proposed: Alex, subject to sponsor agreement.
No budget or benefit percentage has been approved.

What good looks like

- Attainment is shown as a 2.82 percentage-point decrease, not a 2.82% relative change.
- The last slide requests permission for a pilot rather than claiming it is approved.

Check before you use it

- Charts use the same periods and denominators as the report.

- All slide content remains editable.

Something to keep

A short deck designed to support a decision.

Go further: Prepare a three-slide executive version with the same evidence.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: creating across Workspace apps

https://workspace.google.com/blog/product-announcements/less-switching-more-flow-5-new-agentic-capabilities-across-google-workspace-apps

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 21 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Save a Repeatable Task as Instructions

Capture the method behind a successful service reply.

For: Everyone, IT, HR, Quality
Tools: Gems / Skills, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The assistant specification and current practice procedure. Use the feature available in your managed account.

Try it, step by step

1. Read the specification and identify required inputs and stop conditions.
2. Use the prompt to draft reusable instructions.
3. Save in the available Gem/Skill experience or a clearly versioned Doc.
4. Try enquiry A in a fresh interaction and verify the source and review section.

Your starting prompt

Create reusable instructions for the Service Reply Drafting Helper described below. Include purpose, required inputs, source precedence, output sections, limits, review checklist and when to ask for clarification. Use the current supplied procedure as the source of facts, never general memory. Do not claim the assistant can grant access or send messages.

Paste the specification and procedure.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Reusable assistant specification (TEXT)

Assistant name: Service Reply Drafting Helper.
Task: prepare draft replies to access enquiries using the supplied procedure.
Required inputs: enquiry and current procedure with version/date.
Output: case summary; facts; missing information; draft reply; source section; human review questions.
Limits: never grant access, invent a completion date, change authorization, or infer permission from urgency.
If the procedure is missing or contradictory, ask for clarification before drafting advice.
Training references: Access Request Procedure v2.0 and Three fictional service enquiries.

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.
6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the

system owner.
No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

Three fictional service enquiries (TEXT)

A. I need access to the training reporting system. Work email: alex@example.com. Business reason: weekly reporting. Manager approval reference: M-27.
B. Please give me access to the reporting system urgently.
C. I am a contractor and need emergency payroll access tonight.
Use Access Request Procedure v2.0.
Expected handling: A still needs system-owner authorization; B needs the missing required information; C is outside the procedure and must be referred to the system owner. Urgency is not permission.

What good looks like

- Missing or contradictory source material triggers clarification.
- An answer remains a draft for a human to check.

Check before you use it

- Reference files are accessible to intended users before any sharing.
- Instructions are saved with an owner and review date supplied by you.

Something to keep

Versioned reusable instructions for a narrow business task.

Go further: Test enquiry C and confirm the assistant respects the scope boundary.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gems or Skills is unavailable during the rollout, save the complete instructions in a Doc and paste them at the start of a fresh Gemini conversation. Test the same cases; do not assume instructions transfer between apps.

Official guidance

Google: Gems to Skills transition and rollout updates

https://workspaceupdates.googleblog.com/2026/09/skills-gemini-app-workspace.html?hl=en_UG

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 22 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Process Explainer in Vids

Teach a simple process in a short, accurate video.

For: Learning & Development, IT, HR, Communications
Tools: Vids, Docs / 20 minutes

Before you begin

Vids access and the fictional procedure saved in an editable training Doc.

Try it, step by step

1. Choose a 90-second limit and a new-starter audience.

2. In Vids use Help me create where available and add the training Doc as a related file; otherwise start with a template.

3. Review the outline, then edit the script and narration scene by scene.

4. Check caption text, factual accuracy, readable timing and the final source reference.

Your starting prompt

Create a 90-second training explainer from this procedure: why the form matters, required inputs, authorization step, urgent requests, exceptions, and where to ask for help. Give six scenes with narration and concise on-screen text. Label all material fictional training. Do not invent delivery times, a portal URL or a policy promise.

Use the practice procedure as the related source.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.
6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the system owner.
No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

What good looks like

- Authorization remains explicit; urgent does not mean automatically approved.

- The video directs viewers to the full procedure for exceptions.

Check before you use it

- Read the narration against the source.
- Review captions and timing; generated media does not imply a real workplace or employee.

Something to keep

A checked process-video draft with an editable script.

Go further: Create a 30-second reminder using the same approved facts.

If a feature is unavailable

If Vids or an AI video feature is unavailable, create the storyboard and narration in Docs, then build the same scenes in Slides. A checked script is a valid takeaway.

Official guidance

Google: create a first video in Vids

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/14819770?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 23 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Extend a Studio Request Workflow

Handle complete, incomplete and uncertain requests deliberately.

For: Operations, HR, IT, Finance
Tools: Workspace Studio, Gmail / 25 minutes

Before you begin

A copy of the Day 5 training flow, or build its starter and extraction first. Send notifications only to yourself.

Try it, step by step

1. Use the TRAINING-REQUEST starter and place extraction at the top level so its variables are available later.

2. Add Decide to check whether all four required fields are explicit and dates agree. Review its paired Check if condition.

3. In the true substeps notify yourself with Ready for review; add a separate top-level Check if for false and notify Needs clarification. Keep notifications inside their respective branches.

4. Run A, B and D, and confirm C is excluded by the starter. Check there is exactly one notification per relevant message, then disable the test flow.

Your starting prompt

Extend my training request flow. After extracting requester, audience, deliverable and deadline, use Decide to return true only if all fields are present and the date is unambiguous. Its Check if true branch sends me Ready for review with the brief. A separate Check if false branch sends me Needs clarification with missing or conflicting details. No nested conditions, no sender replies and no automatic approvals. Use variables from the top-level extraction.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Studio test messages (TEXT)

Copy each example into a separate test email sent to your own approved test inbox.
A. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Complete
Body: Requester Alex; audience service managers; deliverable one-page update; deadline 14 December 2026.
B. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Missing details
Body: Please make a service update. Requester Sam.
C. Subject: Lunch plans
Body: Shall we meet at noon?
D. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Conflicting dates
Body: Deadline 14 December. Later note says 16 December, not confirmed. Requester Priya; audience analysts; deliverable FAQ.
Expected: A complete; B needs information; C must not trigger; D requires review. Test runs send actual notifications: use yourself as the recipient.

What good looks like

- A reaches Ready for review; B and D reach Needs clarification.

- C has no run; a run does not send both notifications.

Check before you use it

- Do not refer to branch-only variables from later top-level steps.
- Incomplete requests never get described as authorized.

Something to keep

A branching flow with a documented test matrix and owner.

Go further: Document how the owner will inspect failures and switch off the flow.

If a feature is unavailable

If Studio or an AI step is unavailable, paste each test message into Gemini, apply the same extraction and routing rules, and record the expected notification in a Doc. This teaches the workflow without enabling automation.

Official guidance

Google: conditional steps in Studio

https://support.google.com/workspace-studio/answer/16431010?hl=en

Google: Studio starters, steps and variables

https://support.google.com/workspace-studio/table/17176961?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 24 / PRACTICAL WORK, ONE USEFUL TASK AT A TIME

Personal AI Toolkit for 2027

Keep the workflows that proved useful and decide how to maintain them.

For: Everyone, Leadership
Tools: Docs, Sheets / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Your own notes or the fictional activity log; do not claim sample benefits as personal results.

Try it, step by step

1. Review the activities you tried and choose three potential habits.
2. For measured runs calculate baseline minus drafting and review time.
3. Write the sources, checks, limitations and maintenance needs for each habit.
4. Set a January review date and one concrete action for the first week back.

Your starting prompt

Using this activity log, calculate net time per run as baseline minus AI draft time minus review time. Separate measured, sample and untested results. Propose one daily habit, one reusable assistant and one optional automation, with required inputs, human checks, known limits and a 30-day review. Do not infer cash savings or adoption from these few runs.

Paste the log and label whether it is fictional or your own.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A fictional activity and benefits log (CSV)

```
workflow,baseline_min,ai_draft_min,review_min,runs,quality_check
Email brief,12,3,4,3,All facts checked
KPI update,25,8,12,2,One denominator corrected
Studio notification,5,0,1,4,One unrelated trigger fixed
Video guide,,,,0,Not tested
```

What good looks like

- Sample net minutes per run: email 5, KPI 5, Studio 4.
- Untested video has no measured saving; corrections and setup effort are discussed.

Check before you use it

- Training numbers are not reported as company outcomes.
- Each retained workflow has a review step and a real owner if shared.

Something to keep

A personal toolkit and a realistic January follow-up plan.

Go further: Compare notes with your team and agree which single shared method to maintain first.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again